

KIQ 1.3 — Final Takeaway

How do METRO's digital ordering channels contribute to customer retention, as reflected in repeat use, convenience, and loyalty signals?

Methodological positioning

This project's required analytical toolkit is **patent analysis (Espacenet)** and **scientific-literature analysis (SCOPUS)** via text mining (occurrence, co-occurrence, n-grams). The KIT 1 strategy is therefore **course-method-first**: SCOPUS and patent corpora are used as the primary evidence base wherever a KIQ permits, and direct web scraping is deliberately reserved for the single question where literature and patents structurally cannot answer — **direct customer perception (KIQ 1.4)**. For KIQ 1.3 the evidence base is **SCOPUS literature**, analysed by occurrence and co-occurrence network analysis. The literature surfaces the retention *mechanisms* associated with digital commerce; METRO is then read through that mechanism map.

Core finding

Customer satisfaction sits at the structural centre of the retention discourse. It connects service quality, customer experience, and trust on one side to customer loyalty and repurchase intention on the other. The retention chain — experience / service quality / trust → satisfaction → loyalty / repurchase intention → retention — is empirically supported by the co-occurrence network (the thickest links are satisfaction–service quality, satisfaction–loyalty, satisfaction–repurchase intention).

Convenience, although named in the KIQ, does not appear as a standalone term — it manifests *through* service quality and customer experience, both confirmed as central nodes.

Periphery as a bridge to KIT 2

AI, machine learning, CRM, information systems and marketplaces sit at the **edge** of the network — connected to the core but not part of it. The literature treats these technologies as **enablers** of retention mechanisms, not as drivers themselves: technology amplifies the satisfaction–loyalty chain, it does not replace it. This sets up KIT 2 directly — the early-warning question becomes which mechanisms in the chain those technologies amplify most.

Direct answer to KIQ 1.3

Scientific literature indicates that digital ordering channels retain customers primarily through **satisfaction**, sustained by service quality, trust and customer experience, and expressed behaviourally as loyalty and repurchase intention. Convenience operates inside this chain rather than beside it. Emerging digital technologies appear as enabling layers around the core, not substitutes for it. For METRO, this means retention from its digital channels depends on getting the satisfaction mechanics right — reliability, ease, trust — a conclusion that KIQ 1.4 then tests against METRO's actual customers.

Method bridge to KIQ 1.4

KIQ 1.3 deliberately uses the SCOPUS proxy: the literature reliably theorises retention *mechanisms*, so the course method applies cleanly and no scraping is needed here. The next question — KIQ 1.4, METRO's strengths and weaknesses from the customer's own voice — cannot be answered by literature, so it is the single point where direct app-store review evidence is introduced. The two KIQs are complementary by design: **mechanism map from literature (1.3), lived experience from customers (1.4)**.